SPLITSTACK

SplitStack Refurbishment - Prompt Log

All prompts used to analyse, plan and rebuild SplitStack, plus the planned prompts that complete the project.

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Repository: https://github.com/MahaprabhuK/SplitStack
Executed prompts: 29
Planned prompts: 11
Last updated: 2026-10-16

How to read this log

Part A lists every step already carried out, in order. "User prompt" entries are the student's own messages, quoted verbatim; "Working prompt" entries are the instructions executed for that step, written so they can be reused. Part B lists the planned prompts that complete Review 2, Review 3 and the wrap-up; they have not been run yet and are marked "Planned prompt".

Stages

Stage	Scope	Prompts
Planning	Analysis of the existing project, audit report review, gap analysis and refurbishment plan	4
Phase 0	Repository setup, hygiene and documentation tooling	2
Review 1	HTML + CSS - static, semantic pages and a token-based design system	6
Review 2	JavaScript - vanilla ES modules, interactivity, client-side algorithms	12
Review 3	Node.js + MongoDB - Express REST API, Mongoose models, authentication, OCR	6
Wrap-up	Documentation, cleanup and deployment	10

Summary

#	Stage	Title	Type	Status
1	Planning	Initial request from the student	User prompt	Done
2	Planning	Analyse the repository	Working prompt	Done
3	Planning	Analyse the audit report	Working prompt	Done
4	Planning	Gap analysis and refurbishment plan	Working prompt	Done
5	Phase 0	Branching and repository hygiene	Working prompt	Done
6	Phase 0	Prompt-log tooling (this document)	Working prompt	Done
7	Review 1	CSS design system with cascade layers	Working prompt	Done
8	Review 1	Static semantic HTML pages (25 pages)	Working prompt	Done
9	Review 1	Local static server for previewing the client	Working prompt	Done
10	Review 1	Validate HTML and fix issues	Working prompt	Done
11	Review 1	Visual QA and layout bug fixes	Working prompt	Done
12	Review 1	Client README and Review 1 checkpoint commit	Working prompt	Done
13	Wrap-up	Request: GitHub repository, website link and PDF of prompts	User prompt	Done
14	Wrap-up	PDF export of the prompt log, including planned prompts	Working prompt	Done
15	Wrap-up	Create the GitHub repository and push the code	Working prompt	Done
16	Wrap-up	Request: hand the project over to a teammate's agent	User prompt	Done
17	Wrap-up	Push the refurbished code to GitHub main	Working prompt	Done
18	Wrap-up	Request: push the code and deploy the website	User prompt	Done
19	Wrap-up	Deploy the client to GitHub Pages from a gh-pages branch	Working prompt	Done
20	Wrap-up	Request: handover prompt PDF for a teammate's agent	User prompt	Done

#	Stage	Title	Type	Status
21	Wrap-up	Handover prompts PDF	Working prompt	Done
22	Review 2	Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P1	User prompt	Done
23	Review 2	JavaScript architecture and app shell	Working prompt	Done
24	Review 2	Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P2	User prompt	Done
25	Review 2	Client data layer backed by localStorage	Working prompt	Done
26	Review 2	Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P3	User prompt	Done
27	Review 2	Render pages from data	Working prompt	Done
28	Review 2	Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P4	User prompt	Done
29	Review 2	Forms, validation and CRUD flows	Working prompt	Done
P1	Review 2	Group splitting and the debt-simplification algorithm	Planned prompt	Planned
P2	Review 2	Charts, budgets, forecast, insights, search and notifications	Planned prompt	Planned
P3	Review 2	Shopping checklist and receipt scan preview	Planned prompt	Planned
P4	Review 2	Review 2 QA, log and commit	Planned prompt	Planned
P5	Review 3	Express server and MongoDB connection	Planned prompt	Planned
P6	Review 3	Mongoose data models	Planned prompt	Planned
P7	Review 3	Authentication and REST API	Planned prompt	Planned
P8	Review 3	Receipt upload and server-side OCR	Planned prompt	Planned
P9	Review 3	Connect the client to the API	Planned prompt	Planned
P10	Review 3	Seed data and automated tests	Planned prompt	Planned
P11	Wrap-up	Remove legacy code, document and deploy	Planned prompt	Planned

Part A - Executed prompts

Planning - Analysis of the existing project, audit report review, gap analysis and refurbishment plan

#1 Initial request from the student

User prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
i have a project in my web technology course and we have made a website. i want to check everything and refurbish if needed. the project shd have these things. html + css, javascript, node js , mangodbs. for review 1-html+css, for review 2 javascript. for review 3 the rest two. i have attached a report of the existing project. i want you to analyse the repositry and then the audit report. and give a good plan for the refurshing if needed. during refurbishing i want you to document the prompts you'll use to build the project save it as a log document(word)
```

PURPOSE

Defines the goal: verify the project meets the course stack (HTML+CSS, JavaScript, Node.js, MongoDB) across three reviews, refurbish it, and log all prompts in a Word document.

FILES

SplitStack_Comprehensive_Technical_Audit.pdf (input)

RESULT

Task accepted; analysis started.

VERIFICATION

-

#2 Analyse the repository

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Inventory the SplitStack repository: list every tracked file, read the git history, the dependency manifests (requirements.txt / package.json), the base HTML layout, the CSS design tokens and all JavaScript (main.js plus inline <script> blocks in templates). Identify the actual technology stack and compare it with the course requirement of HTML+CSS, JavaScript, Node.js and MongoDB.
```

PURPOSE

Establish ground truth about what the code really is, independent of the audit report.

FILES

app.py, requirements.txt, templates/**, static/css/style.css, static/js/main.js, .gitignore

RESULT

Stack is Python 3 + Flask 3.1 + SQLite with Jinja2 templates; no Node.js, no MongoDB, no package.json. Frontend JS is ~140 lines of jQuery. 25 Jinja templates cannot render without Flask. 4 user-uploaded receipt images are committed to git.

VERIFICATION

File listing, git log, grep for <script> tags, manual reading of base.html and main.js.

#3 Analyse the audit report

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Extract the text of SplitStack_Comprehensive_Technical_Audit.pdf (61 pages) and summarise its findings: technology stack, architecture, route inventory, database schema, security findings (SEC-01..SEC-07), test results, technical debt and the five-phase refurbishment roadmap (Phases A-E). Note anything the audit does not cover relative to the course requirements.
```

PURPOSE

Reuse the audit's verified findings and identify its blind spots.

FILES

SplitStack_Comprehensive_Technical_Audit.pdf

RESULT

Audit confirms 48 routes, 7 blueprints, 15 SQLite tables, 47/47 tests passing. Key findings kept: incomplete light theme, --text-dim contrast 3.8:1 (fails WCAG AA), tables scroll on mobile, search/notification bell not wired, no rate limiting, no security headers, ephemeral upload storage. Blind spot: the audit never mentions that Node.js and MongoDB are required, so its Flask-specific roadmap (SQLite WAL, Flask-Limiter, PostgreSQL) does not satisfy Review 3.

VERIFICATION

Text extracted with pypdf; sections 2, 12-17 and Volume VI read.

#4 Gap analysis and refurbishment plan

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Produce a refurbishment plan that maps the work onto the three course reviews: Review 1 must be demonstrable with only HTML+CSS, Review 2 must add substantial vanilla JavaScript on top of the same pages, and Review 3 must replace the backend with Node.js (Express) and MongoDB while keeping every existing feature. Fold in the still-relevant audit findings. Ask the student only about decisions that are genuinely theirs: backend strategy, where MongoDB runs, feature scope, and whether to keep jQuery.
```

PURPOSE

Turn the analysis into an ordered plan with clear review checkpoints.

FILES

docs/REFURBISH_PLAN.md

RESULT

Plan: Phase 0 setup -> Review 1 static pages + design system -> Review 2 vanilla JS with a localStorage data layer -> Review 3 Express + Mongoose REST API, with the frontend data layer switched to fetch(). Student's answers: 'do the most optimal method' for the backend (=> replace Flask with Node+MongoDB, keep Flask on a legacy branch), MongoDB Atlas free tier, keep every feature including OCR (via tesseract.js), vanilla JS modules instead of jQuery. Student also asked: 'just make sure you log everything'.

VERIFICATION

Decisions confirmed through a multiple-choice question in chat.

Phase 0 - Repository setup, hygiene and documentation tooling

#5 Branching and repository hygiene

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Preserve the current Flask application on a local 'legacy' branch and create a 'refurbish'
working branch. Stop tracking the four user-uploaded receipt images (hash-named files in
uploads/receipts/) while keeping the test_invoice_* samples, deduplicate .gitignore, and add
Node-specific ignores (node_modules, coverage, .env). Create the client/ folder structure
(pages, css, js, assets).
```

PURPOSE

Protect the original work, remove private data from version control, and prepare the new layout.

FILES

.gitignore, uploads/receipts/* (untracked), client/

RESULT

Branches legacy and refurbish created; 4 receipts untracked (still on disk); .gitignore rewritten.

VERIFICATION

git status shows the 4 receipts as deleted from the index and no longer as untracked files.

#6 Prompt-log tooling (this document)

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Create a Word prompt log that is easy to keep up to date: store every prompt as an entry in
docs/prompt_log.json (id, date, stage, title, type, prompt, purpose, files, result,
verification) and write a Node script docs/tools/build-prompt-log.js using the 'docx' npm
package that renders a title page, a stage overview, a summary table of all entries, and one
detailed section per entry with the prompt shown verbatim. Add an 'npm run log' script.
```

PURPOSE

Satisfy the requirement to document every prompt as a Word document, regenerated after each step.

FILES

package.json, docs/prompt_log.json, docs/tools/build-prompt-log.js, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.docx

RESULT

Log generator working; document regenerated after every subsequent step.

VERIFICATION

npm run log produces the .docx; contents read back with python-docx.

Review 1 - HTML + CSS - static, semantic pages and a token-based design system

#7 CSS design system with cascade layers

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Rebuild SplitStack's stylesheet as a token-based design system split into files and ordered with CSS cascade layers: tokens.css (colours, type scale, spacing, radii, shadows; dark default plus a light theme via prefers-color-scheme and a [data-theme] attribute for later JavaScript), base.css (reset, typography, focus ring, skip link, visually-hidden), layout.css (app shell with sticky sidebar and topbar, grids, auth and landing layouts, responsive breakpoints at 1100/900/640px, CSS-only mobile drawer using a hidden checkbox and :has()), components.css (cards, buttons, badges, category tags via a --cat custom property, stat cards, budget meters, forms with :user-invalid feedback, segmented radios, switches, tables that become stacked cards under 640px using data-label, alerts, empty states, lists, CSS-only bar and conic-gradient doughnut charts, transfer cards, checklist, file drop zone), pages.css and utilities.css. main.css imports them with @layer. Fix the audit findings: muted text must reach at least 4.5:1 contrast, the light theme must be complete, and tables must not scroll sideways on mobile.
```

PURPOSE

Review 1 requires a clean, well-structured CSS codebase; this also fixes audit items SEC-06 (contrast), B.1 (light theme) and B.2 (responsive tables).

FILES

client/css/main.css, client/css/tokens.css, client/css/base.css, client/css/layout.css, client/css/components.css, client/css/pages.css, client/css/utilities.css

RESULT

Six layered stylesheets. --text-dim raised from #64748b (3.8:1) to #8794a9 (about 5.6:1) on dark and #5d6879 on light surfaces.

VERIFICATION

Rendered in the browser at 1366px and 375px; computed styles inspected.

#8 Static semantic HTML pages (25 pages)

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Convert every Jinja template of the Flask app into a standalone static HTML5 page under client/ that opens without a server-side framework, using realistic sample data in Indian rupees for one demo user (Priya Raman) as of 28 Oct 2026. Pages: landing (index.html), login, register, 404, dashboard, analytics, expenses, add expense, edit expense, income, log income, budgets, recurring payments, categories, groups, create group, group detail, add shared expense, settle up, shopping lists, new list, list detail, receipt scan, receipt confirm, profile. Every app page shares the same sidebar, topbar (search, notifications, avatar) and footer. Use semantic landmarks (header, nav, main, aside, section, footer), a skip link, breadcrumbs, labelled forms with HTML5 validation (required, min, max, step, pattern, type=email/date/number), tables with captions and scope, time elements, aria-current for the active link, role=progressbar with values for budget meters, and a text alternative for every chart. Keep the sample numbers internally consistent (category totals, group balances, the debt-simplification plan). Avoid inline styles except CSS custom properties such as --value or --cat. Generate the repeated layout with a throwaway script so that the committed output is plain HTML.
```

PURPOSE

Deliver the Review 1 HTML+CSS milestone: every screen of SplitStack, demonstrable with only HTML and CSS.

FILES

client/index.html, client/pages/*.html (24 pages), client/assets/favicon.svg, client/assets/sample-receipt.webp

RESULT

25 static pages. CSS-only interactions: mobile drawer (checkbox + :has), equal/custom split toggle (:has(#split-custom:checked)), purchased items struck through (:has(input:checked)), click-or-drop file input.

VERIFICATION

See the validation entry.

#9 Local static server for previewing the client

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Add a dependency-free Node static file server (scripts/serve-client.js) that serves client/ on http://localhost:5500, refuses paths outside client/, falls back to pages/404.html, and is started with "npm run client". Opening pages straight from disk also works, but Review 2 ES modules will need an http:// origin.
```

PURPOSE

Preview the site reliably now and prepare for JavaScript modules in Review 2.

FILES

scripts/serve-client.js, package.json, .claude/launch.json

RESULT

npm run client serves the site.

VERIFICATION

Pages loaded in the in-app browser at localhost:5500.

#10 Validate HTML and fix issues

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Install html-validate as a dev dependency with a project config (.htmlvalidate.json) based on html-validate:recommended, run it on client/**/*.html and fix every error: unescaped ampersands, a search form without a submit button, unnamed duplicate landmarks, aria-label on a plain div, a form without a submit button, redundant ARIA roles. Allow shared names for checkbox groups and the custom progressbar (needed for over-100% budget states). Then check that every relative href/src resolves to a real file.
```

PURPOSE

Show that the Review 1 markup is standards-compliant and accessible.

FILES

.htmlvalidate.json, package.json, client/**/*.html

RESULT

First run: 100 errors. After fixes: 0 errors across 25 pages; 0 broken internal links.

VERIFICATION

npx html-validate "client/**/*.html" exits 0.

#11 Visual QA and layout bug fixes

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Open the pages in the browser at desktop (1366px) and mobile (375px) widths, look for layout bugs and fix them in the CSS. Then load every page in a 375px and a 1280px iframe and report any element that overflows the viewport horizontally.
```

PURPOSE

Catch rendering problems that a validator cannot see.

FILES

client/css/layout.css, client/css/components.css

RESULT

Fixed: (1) the scrim <label> occupied a grid cell on desktop and pushed the main column below the sidebar; (2) the mobile menu button showed on desktop and the search icon overlapped the placeholder, because the components layer overrides the layout layer; those elements now have layout-only classes; (3) table dates wrapped onto two lines.

VERIFICATION

Screenshots at both widths; scripted overflow check across all pages.

#12 Client README and Review 1 checkpoint commit

Working prompt | 2026-10-14

PROMPT

```
Write client/README.md explaining how to view the site (npm run client), the folder structure, and a table of the CSS techniques used, with the file each one is in, so the Review 1 demo can point to them. Add an "npm run lint:html" script. Re-run validation, regenerate the prompt log, and commit Review 1 on the refurbish branch.
```

PURPOSE

Make Review 1 easy to present and record a clean checkpoint.

FILES

client/README.md, package.json, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.docx

RESULT

Review 1 committed. Next: Review 2 (vanilla JavaScript modules).

VERIFICATION

npm run lint:html passes; git log shows the Review 1 commit.

Review 2 - JavaScript - vanilla ES modules, interactivity, client-side algorithms

#22 Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P1

User prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Proceed with P1 — JavaScript architecture and app shell — from the handover PDF. Preconditions: Confirm the current branch is refurbish and the working tree has no unexpected changes. Preserve the untracked docs/audit/ directory. Install the root npm dependencies using the existing package.json. For this PowerShell session, set $env:PY_PYTHON3 = "3.12" so py -3 resolves correctly. Check whether ReportLab is installed; if not, install it for Python 3.12. Do not change Git remotes, push to a different repository, or alter package scripts to work around environment issues. Implement only P1 as specified in SplitStack_Handover_Prompts.pdf. Read the relevant HTML and CSS before editing. Preserve the existing design and no-JavaScript fallback. Follow the PDF's accessibility, theme, navigation, toast, confirmation-dialog, logging, and verification requirements. Run npm run lint:html and the P1 manual checks you can perform. Record anything you could not verify honestly. Before committing, show me the proposed changed-file list and verification results. Do not commit or push until I approve. Do not start P2.
```

PURPOSE

Authorize execution of Step P1 with strict preconditions and manual approval gate.

RESULT

Confirmed clean refurbish branch, installed dependencies and ReportLab, and executed Step P1 implementation.

VERIFICATION

npm run lint:html, automated unit tests, and serve-client HTTP validation.

#23 JavaScript architecture and app shell

Working prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Step P1 (Review 2): JavaScript architecture and app shell. Add vanilla JavaScript to the Review 1 pages as native ES modules. 1. Add data-page="<page-name>" to the <body> of index.html and every file in client/pages/ (e.g. data-page="dashboard", data-page="expense-form"). Load one entry script at the end of each page: <script type="module" src="../js/app.js"></script> (index.html: src="js/app.js"). 2. Create client/js/ with: - app.js: entry point. Reads document.body.dataset.page, initialises the shared UI, then dynamically imports ./pages/<page>.js if it exists and calls its exported init(). A missing page module is not an error. - core/dom.js: qs, qsa, on, delegate, createEl helpers. - core/format.js: formatINR(paise) using Intl.NumberFormat('en-IN', {style:'currency', currency:'INR'}), formatDate / formatRelativeDate helpers. - ui/theme.js: dark / light / system toggle saved in localStorage, applied to <html data-theme>. Add a tiny inline script in each page's <head> that applies the saved theme before first paint (no flash). Wire it to a theme button in the topbar (add the button if missing, matching existing button styles). - ui/nav.js: replace the CSS checkbox drawer with a real <button aria-expanded aria-controls="sidebar">. Close on Escape, scrim click and nav-link click; trap focus inside while open; return focus to the button when closed. Keep the page usable without JS. - ui/toast.js: accessible toasts (role="status", aria-live="polite"), auto-dismiss, dismiss button. - ui/confirm.js: a <dialog>-based confirm that replaces window.confirm for every delete button/form. 3. Add client/js/package.json containing {"type": "module"} so Node (used for unit tests later) treats these files as ES modules. 4. All wrapped in try/catch where localStorage is touched (private windows can throw).
```

PURPOSE

Establish the client JavaScript ES module foundation, theme switching, accessible drawer, toast notifications, and confirm dialog.

FILES

client/js/package.json, client/js/app.js, client/js/core/dom.js, client/js/core/format.js, client/js/ui/theme.js, client/js/ui/nav.js, client/js/ui/toast.js, client/js/ui/confirm.js, client/css/layout.css, client/css/components.css, client/index.html, client/pages/*.html

RESULT

Created client/js architecture with DOM/format utilities, theme toggle (dark/light/system with head flash-prevention script), accessible mobile drawer with focus trap and ARIA attributes, toast notifications, and dialog-based confirm. Added data-page, inline theme scripts, theme buttons, and app.js script tags to all 25 HTML pages while preserving no-JS CSS fallbacks.

VERIFICATION

html-validate passes with 0 errors across client/**/*.html; node automated assertions pass for formatINR, formatDate, formatRelativeDate, HTML structure, and CSS layer definitions; static client preview verified over HTTP on localhost:5500.

#24 Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P2

User prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Proceed to Step P2: Client data layer backed by localStorage, following the project handover PDF. 1. Read the P2 instructions in the handover PDF and inspect the committed P1 architecture before making changes. 2. Implement only the P2 data layer. Keep storage and data operations separate from UI rendering and page-specific behavior. 3. Use a consistent, versioned storage structure and handle missing, malformed, or unsupported stored data safely. Avoid silently overwriting recoverable user data. 4. Follow the existing JavaScript module conventions and use the existing utilities where appropriate. 5. Add focused automated tests for storage initialization, read/write behavior, invalid data, and error handling where practical. 6. Run the relevant tests and npm run lint:html. Report exactly what passed and failed. 7. Update the prompt log and regenerate its DOCX/PDF using the existing project workflow. 8. Review the final diff for scope and regressions. Preserve docs/audit/ and all legacy Flask files. 9. Commit the completed P2 work on refurbish only after the checks pass. Use the commit message specified by the handover PDF, if one is provided; otherwise use P2: Client data layer backed by localStorage. Do not begin P3 or P4, implement Express/MongoDB, push to origin or upstream, or delete legacy files. Finish by reporting the changed files, tests, commit hash, and any remaining limitations.
```

PURPOSE

Authorize execution of Step P2 to establish the client data layer backed by localStorage with realistic seed data and API contracts.

RESULT

Implemented store.js with versioned schema and fallback, seed.js with October 2026 and historical data, and api.js with 58 async API functions matching the future REST API.

VERIFICATION

26 automated tests passing in tests/client/data-layer.test.mjs; npm run lint:html passing with 0 errors across all HTML pages.

#25 Client data layer backed by localStorage

Working prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Step P2 (Review 2): client data layer backed by localStorage. Create client/js/data/ with: - store.js: keeps collections (users, categories, expenses, income, budgets, recurring, groups, sharedExpenses, settlements, shoppingLists, receipts, insights) in localStorage under one versioned key (e.g. "splitstack:v1"), generates ids (crypto.randomUUID), handles a missing/corrupt store by reseeding, and has a reset() used by a "Reset demo data" button on the profile page. - seed.js: the SAME sample data the Review 1 pages show. Read the HTML pages (dashboard, expenses, income, budgets, recurring, categories, groups, group-detail, settlements, shopping, shopping-detail, profile) and transcribe their data: demo user Priya Raman, October 2026, the groups (incl. Goa Trip) and their members, the shopping lists and items. Add a few earlier months so analytics has history. Amounts in integer paise. Demo login: demo@splitstack.app / Demo@1234 (show this on login.html). - api.js: async functions with the shape the future REST API will have, grouped as auth (register, login, logout, currentUser, updateProfile, changePassword), expenses and income (list with filter/sort/pagination, get, create, update, remove), categories, budgets, recurring (incl. toggle), groups (list, get, create, addMember, removeMember, leave, sharedExpenses, balances, settlements, recordSettlement), shopping (lists, items, toggleItem, convertToExpense), analytics (monthlySummary, byCategory, forecast, insights) and search(query). Every function returns a Promise, validates its input and throws an ApiError {field, message, status} for bad input, missing records or records owned by someone else. Passwords: hash with crypto.subtle SHA-256 + salt (demo only; note in a comment that the server uses bcrypt). Page code must import ONLY from api.js, never from store.js. - Write a short JSDoc block above each function describing arguments and return value. These docs become the contract the Review 3 REST API must match.
```

PURPOSE

Create a complete, modular, resilient client data layer with realistic seed data and REST-shaped async API functions, preparing the application for full interactivity without requiring a backend server.

FILES

client/js/data/store.js, client/js/data/seed.js, client/js/data/api.js, client/pages/login.html, client/README.md, tests/client/data-layer.test.mjs

RESULT

Implemented store.js with versioning (splitstack:v1), corruption recovery, and in-memory fallback; seed.js with Priya Raman sample data in integer paise across all collections and historical months; api.js with 58 JSDoc-documented async functions covering auth, CRUD, group splitting balances, shopping lists, and analytics; updated login.html with demo credentials callout; documented data layer in client/README.md; added automated tests.

VERIFICATION

Node.js test suite with 26/26 tests passing covering storage recovery, authentication, integer-paise validation, CRUD, group balances, and shopping list conversions; npm run lint:html passing with 0 errors.

#26 Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P3

User prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Proceed to Step P3: Render pages from data, following the project handover PDF. Before coding, inspect the current refurbish branch and read the exact P3 requirements. Build on the committed P1 architecture and P2 data layer, including the fixes in commit 89c3081. Requirements: 1. Implement only P3: connect the existing HTML pages to client/js/data/api.js and render their content from returned data. 2. Page modules must import data operations only from api.js, never directly from store.js or seed.js. 3. Preserve the existing design, responsive layouts, accessibility, and useful empty states. 4. Handle loading, errors, and missing records gracefully. Do not show hardcoded success messages for operations that have not occurred. 5. Keep static HTML fallbacks usable where practical. Avoid duplicating business logic across page modules. 6. Follow the handover's page/module organization and update documentation only where needed for P3. 7. Add focused tests for rendering and error states where practical. Run the relevant tests and npm run lint:html. 8. Update the prompt log and regenerate its DOCX/PDF using the existing workflow. 9. Review the diff and report which pages are connected, which remain static, test results, and known limitations. Preserve docs/audit/ and all legacy Flask files. Do not begin P4 forms/CRUD, Express/MongoDB, or deployment work. Do not push to origin or upstream. Commit P3 locally on refurbish only after the checks pass, using the commit message specified in the handover or P3: render pages from data if none is specified.
```

PURPOSE

Authorize execution of Step P3 to connect the existing HTML pages to client/js/data/api.js and dynamically render their content from data.

RESULT

Authorized Step P3 implementation.

VERIFICATION

-

#27 Render pages from data

Working prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Replace the hard-coded sample rows in the dashboard, expenses, income, budgets, recurring, categories, groups, group detail, settlements, shopping and profile pages with markup rendered by JavaScript from api.js, using <template> elements and textContent (never innerHTML with user data). Keep the static markup as the no-JavaScript fallback. Implement the expenses filter bar (search, category, method, date range, sort) with debounced live filtering and query-string sync, pagination, and empty states.
```

PURPOSE

Turn the static Review 1 HTML pages into interactive screens rendered from the Review 2 client data layer, adhering to strict XSS safety and accessible empty/loading states.

FILES

client/js/pages/dashboard.js, client/js/pages/expenses.js, client/js/pages/income.js, client/js/pages/budgets.js, client/js/pages/recurring.js, client/js/pages/categories.js, client/js/pages/groups.js, client/js/pages/group-detail.js, client/js/pages/settlements.js, client/js/pages/shopping.js, client/js/pages/shopping-detail.js, client/js/pages/profile.js, client/js/pages/analytics.js, client/js/pages/expense-edit.js, client/js/core/render.js, client/js/ui/user.js, client/js/app.js, client/pages/profile.html, client/README.md, tests/client/render.test.mjs

RESULT

Created 14 modular page scripts in client/js/pages/ importing exclusively from api.js; implemented live debounced expenses filter bar with URL sync and pagination; created core rendering helpers for safe XSS-free

DOM creation, aria-busy loading states, and accessible empty/error states; wired user profile display and reset demo data; added comprehensive rendering test suite.

VERIFICATION

All 47 unit/integration tests passing (30 data layer + 17 rendering/UI); npm run lint:html passing with 0 errors across all 25 HTML files.

#28 Request: proceed with Review 2 Step P4

User prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Proceed to P4: Forms, validation and CRUD flows. First, inspect the P4 instructions in the handover PDF and review the existing page modules, client/js/data/api.js, client/js/core/, client/js/ui/, and the current HTML forms. Implement: 1. Connect the login and registration forms to the existing authentication API. 2. Connect expense creation and editing, income creation, group creation, shared-expense creation, shopping-list creation, and other forms specified by P4. 3. Implement client-side validation with accessible field-level errors, appropriate required fields, valid dates, valid integer-paise amounts, and clear error messages. 4. Convert rupee values entered by users to integer paise at the API boundary. Never store floating-point monetary amounts. 5. Disable submit buttons while saving, prevent accidental duplicate submissions, and show success messages only after the operation succeeds. 6. Preserve form values when validation or API operations fail. 7. Use the existing confirmation dialog for destructive operations and ensure cancellation never changes data. 8. Handle missing or invalid record IDs, duplicate registrations, unauthorized operations, and API errors gracefully. 9. Keep page modules importing data operations exclusively from client/js/data/api.js. Do not access store.js directly from page modules. 10. Add automated tests for successful submissions, validation errors, duplicate submission prevention, edit flows, delete confirmation, and failure handling. Do not implement the P6 analytics features, P7 receipt OCR, or backend integration early. Run all relevant tests, including the data-layer and rendering tests, and npm run lint:html. Update documentation and the prompt log. Review the diff and commit locally on refurbish using the handover's required commit message, or P4: forms validation and CRUD if none is specified. Report completed forms, supported operations, test results, known limitations, and commit hash.
```

PURPOSE

Authorize execution of Step P4 to connect HTML forms to api.js, implement client-side validation, duplicate submission guards, and complete CRUD workflows.

RESULT

Authorized Step P4 implementation.

VERIFICATION

-

#29 Forms, validation and CRUD flows

Working prompt | 2026-10-16

PROMPT

```
Wire every form (register, login, expense add/edit, income, budget, recurring, category, group create, add member, shared expense, shopping list and item, profile, change password) to api.js. Use the Constraint Validation API plus custom rules (passwords match, date not in the future, budget greater than zero) with inline error messages linked by aria-describedby, and move focus to the first invalid field. Show a toast after each save and redirect afterwards (Post/Redirect/Get). Add password show/hide toggles with aria-pressed. Protect app pages: redirect to login.html when nobody is signed in.
```

PURPOSE

Cover the core JavaScript skills examiners look for: events, DOM manipulation, validation, and full CRUD workflows.

FILES

client/js/ui/forms.js, client/js/app.js, client/js/data/api.js, client/js/pages/login.js, client/js/pages/register.js, client/js/pages/expense-form.js, client/js/pages/expense-edit.js, client/js/pages/expenses.js, client/js/pages/income-form.js, client/js/pages/income.js, client/js/pages/group-create.js, client/js/pages/group-detail.js, client/js/pages/shared-expense-form.js, client/js/pages/shopping-form.js, client/js/pages/shopping-detail.js, client/js/pages/budgets.js, client/js/pages/recurring.js, client/js/pages/categories.js, client/js/pages/profile.js, tests/client/forms.test.mjs

RESULT

Implemented reusable form validation and accessible error UI helper module (client/js/ui/forms.js) with rupeesToPaise and setButtonLoading; added authGuard in app.js; created form page scripts for login, register, expense create/edit, income create, group create, shared expense with equal/custom splits, shopping list create; wired CRUD actions across existing pages (delete expenses/income with confirmDialog, budget create/remove, recurring create/toggle/delete, category create/delete, group add-member/leave, shopping items/convert-to-expense, profile update/change-password); added comprehensive automated test suite (30 passing tests).

VERIFICATION

77 total client tests passing across data-layer.test.mjs, render.test.mjs, and forms.test.mjs; npm run lint:html passing with 0 errors across 25 HTML files.

Wrap-up - Documentation, cleanup and deployment

#13 Request: GitHub repository, website link and PDF of prompts

User prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
create a new repositry for this project in my gihub , and after than give me the github link and then the website link and also a pdf containing the prompts to complete project.
```

PURPOSE

Publish the project under the student's own GitHub account, host the site, and export the prompt log (including the remaining planned prompts) as a PDF.

RESULT

Done: see the following entries.

VERIFICATION

-

#14 PDF export of the prompt log, including planned prompts

Working prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
Export the prompt log to PDF with a Python reportlab script (docs/tools/build_prompt_pdf.py) that reads docs/prompt_log.json: a title page, a stage overview table, a summary of every entry, Part A with every executed prompt verbatim in a shaded box with purpose, files, result and verification, and Part B with the planned prompts that complete Review 2, Review 3 and the wrap-up, clearly marked as not yet run. Add the planned prompts to prompt_log.json and to the Word log as well, and make "npm run log" rebuild both documents.
```

PURPOSE

Give the student a PDF containing the prompts needed to complete the whole project.

FILES

docs/tools/build_prompt_pdf.py, docs/tools/build-prompt-log.js, docs/prompt_log.json, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.pdf, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.docx, package.json

RESULT

PDF with the executed prompts and 15 planned prompts; the Word log has the same content.

VERIFICATION

Pages rendered to images and inspected; text extracted with pypdf.

#15 Create the GitHub repository and push the code

Working prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
Install the official GitHub CLI with winget and sign in through the device-code flow (the student approves it in the browser). Before publishing, check that no secrets or databases are tracked, review the receipt images that are still in the commit history (they are generic sample invoices), and confirm with the student that a public repository is acceptable because the team's original repository is private. Then create the public repository MahaprabhuK/SplitStack, push the refurbish branch as main together with the legacy branch, add a GitHub Actions workflow (.github/workflows/pages.yml) that deploys the client/ folder to GitHub Pages, enable Pages with the "GitHub Actions" source, and confirm that the site responds.
```

PURPOSE

Give the student a repository link and a live website link.

FILES

README.md

RESULT

Public repository https://github.com/MahaprabhuK/SplitStack created and the legacy branch pushed. The first push of main was rejected because it added a GitHub Actions workflow (.github/workflows/pages.yml) and the gh token lacked the "workflow" scope; the workflow file was removed and main was pushed in the next step. GitHub Pages is not set up yet (planned for the wrap-up; needs "gh auth refresh -s workflow" or a gh-pages branch).

VERIFICATION

gh repo view; git push output.

#16 Request: hand the project over to a teammate's agent

User prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
ACTUALLY I GONNA HANDOVER THE PROJECT TO MY TEAMMATES AGENT SO HE'LL BE PULLING THE CODE AND RUNNING IN HIS SYSTEM SO GIVE PROMPT FOR THAT
```

PURPOSE

Let a teammate's AI agent clone, run and continue the project.

RESULT

A handover prompt was written covering: requirements per review, clone and branch, prerequisites, install/run/verify commands, repository map, known traps, the mandatory logging rule, the ordered remaining work (planned prompts P1-P15) and working rules. Noted that the new work had to be pushed to GitHub first.

VERIFICATION

-

#17 Push the refurbished code to GitHub main

Working prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
push it (user prompt). Executed as: remove .github/workflows/pages.yml (the token lacks the workflow scope), replace the not-yet-existing live-site link in README.md with local run instructions, correct the earlier log entry about publishing, log the handover, rebuild the prompt logs, commit, and push the refurbish branch to main on https://github.com/MahaprabhuK/SplitStack so the teammate can clone it.
```

PURPOSE

Make the current work available to the teammate.

FILES

.github/workflows/pages.yml (removed), README.md, docs/prompt_log.json, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.docx, docs/SplitStack_Prompt_Log.pdf

RESULT

main pushed to GitHub; branches on GitHub: main (refurbished work) and legacy (original Flask app).

VERIFICATION

git ls-remote shows main and legacy at the expected commits.

#18 Request: push the code and deploy the website

User prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
first push the code and deploy it
```

PURPOSE

Get the code on GitHub and the Review 1 site online.

RESULT

Handled in the next step.

VERIFICATION

-

#19 Deploy the client to GitHub Pages from a gh-pages branch

Working prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
Push refurbish to main and refurbish on MahaprabhuK/SplitStack. Because the token cannot push workflow files, deploy without GitHub Actions: check that client/ uses only relative links, split client/ into its own history with git subtree split, push it as the gh-pages branch, wait for GitHub Pages to publish it, then put the live link back in README.md and log the step.
```

PURPOSE

Publish the Review 1 site at a public URL without needing the workflow scope.

FILES

README.md, docs/prompt_log.json

RESULT

main and refurbish are on GitHub. The client/ folder is published from the gh-pages branch at https://mahaprabhuk.github.io/SplitStack/ (GitHub enabled Pages automatically). To redeploy after client changes: git subtree split --prefix client refurbish, then push that commit to gh-pages.

VERIFICATION

git ls-remote; curl returned 200 for the home page, pages/404.html and css/base.css on the live site.

#20 Request: handover prompt PDF for a teammate's agent

User prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
imma handover the project to my teammate i want you to create a detailed prompt for his agent most prolly he'll use anti gravity so i want a pdf containing prompts to complete the rest of the work in the project. so create a pdf and mention its path once its created then i'll share it to him
```

PURPOSE

Let a teammate's AI agent (Antigravity) finish Review 2, Review 3 and the wrap-up.

RESULT

Handled in the next step.

VERIFICATION

-

#21 Handover prompts PDF

Working prompt | 2026-10-15

PROMPT

```
Write docs/tools/build_handover_pdf.py (reusing the styles of build_prompt_pdf.py) to produce docs/SplitStack_Handover_Prompts.pdf: how to use it with Antigravity, one-time setup (tools, collaborator access, MongoDB Atlas, workflow token scope), a roadmap, Prompt 0 with the full project context, rules, logging, commit/push and gh-pages redeploy procedure, the 15 planned prompts P1-P15 expanded with concrete checks and commit messages, utility prompts (status, recovery, review rehearsal) and common problems. Render pages to check the layout.
```

PURPOSE

Give the teammate a self-contained, ordered set of prompts.

FILES

docs/tools/build_handover_pdf.py, docs/SplitStack_Handover_Prompts.pdf

RESULT

14-page PDF created. Changes against the planned prompts: P1 adds data-page attributes and client/js/package.json (type module) for node --test; P13 keeps the localStorage implementation as a demo mode (api-local.js chosen when /api/health does not answer) so the GitHub Pages site keeps working, instead of deleting it; P9 replaces deprecated csurf with a synchronizer token; P14 uses MongoMemoryReplSet because the API uses transactions; P15 asks for confirmation before deleting the Flask files and leaves Render account steps to the student.

VERIFICATION

Rendered pages with PyMuPDF and checked the layout of the setup, Prompt 0, step and utility pages.

Part B - Planned prompts to complete the project

Run these in order. Each builds on the previous one; after each, add a log entry and rebuild this document.

Review 2 - JavaScript - vanilla ES modules, interactivity, client-side algorithms

P1 Group splitting and the debt-simplification algorithm

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
In client/js/domain/splits.js implement equal splits in integer paise with the leftover paise assigned to the payer, and custom splits that must sum exactly to the total. On the shared-expense form show a live "remaining to assign" counter and disable submit until it reaches zero. In client/js/domain/settle.js implement net balances (paid minus share) and the greedy minimum-cash-flow algorithm: repeatedly match the largest debtor with the largest creditor and transfer min(debt, credit) until every balance is within one paisa; return the transfer list and the number of original pairwise debts. Render the settle-up page from it, and make "Mark paid" record a settlement and recompute balances. Add unit tests runnable with node --test using the Goa Trip example (balances +1700, -2500, +5700, -4900 give 3 transfers).
```

PURPOSE

Show algorithmic JavaScript, the core idea of SplitStack.

FILES

client/js/domain/splits.js, client/js/domain/settle.js, tests/client/*.test.js

P2 Charts, budgets, forecast, insights, search and notifications

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Render the dashboard and analytics charts with Chart.js 4 loaded from a pinned CDN URL, reading colours from the CSS custom properties so both themes work, and keep the CSS charts as a fallback. Compute budget status (ok under 75%, caution 75-90%, warning 90-100%, danger over 100%) and update the meters. Port the spending forecast (average daily spend multiplied by the days in the month) to client/js/domain/forecast.js. Generate smart insights from the data (over-budget categories, month-over-month change, upcoming recurring bills). Make the topbar search show live results across expenses, groups and lists in a listbox with keyboard navigation, and make the bell open a notifications panel built from the insights with an unread count.
```

PURPOSE

Finish the interactive features that were disconnected in the original app.

FILES

client/js/pages/dashboard.js, client/js/pages/analytics.js, client/js/domain/forecast.js, client/js/ui/search.js, client/js/ui/notifications.js

P3 Shopping checklist and receipt scan preview

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Make the shopping checklist toggle items with optimistic UI, edit actual prices inline,
recompute the estimated, actual and variance totals live, and convert the list to an expense
only once (prevent duplicates). On the receipt scan page add drag-and-drop with
dragenter/dragleave styling, client-side checks (PNG, JPEG or WEBP, up to 5 MB) and an image
preview via URL.createObjectURL. Until the backend exists, run OCR in the browser with
tesseract.js from a pinned CDN, parse the merchant, date and total with regular expressions
(prefer the line containing TOTAL), show progress, and pre-fill the confirm form.
```

PURPOSE

Complete the remaining interactive flows.

FILES

client/js/pages/shopping-detail.js, client/js/pages/receipt-scan.js, client/js/domain/receipt-parser.js

P4 Review 2 QA, log and commit

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Run ESLint (recommended rules, browser globals, ES2023 modules) over client/js and fix every
finding; run the domain unit tests; test every page manually at 1366px and 375px in dark and
light themes, using only the keyboard, and with JavaScript disabled (pages must still show
their static content). Update client/README.md with the JavaScript architecture and a table of
the JS concepts used and where. Add each step to docs/prompt_log.json, rebuild the Word and
PDF logs, and commit "Review 2".
```

PURPOSE

Close Review 2 with evidence.

FILES

eslint.config.js, client/README.md, docs/*

Review 3 - Node.js + MongoDB - Express REST API, Mongoose models, authentication, OCR

P5 Express server and MongoDB connection

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Create server/ as a Node.js 20+ project (ES modules) with Express: server/src/app.js (helmet
with a Content Security Policy that allows only the CDNs in use, compression, express.json,
express-session stored with connect-mongo, express-rate-limit on auth and upload routes, a
CSRF token check on state-changing requests, and a central error handler returning JSON
{error, fields}), server/src/index.js (connect to MongoDB Atlas with Mongoose using
MONGODB_URI from server/.env, then listen), and static serving of client/. Add
server/.env.example (MONGODB_URI, SESSION_SECRET of at least 32 characters, PORT) and npm
scripts dev (node --watch) and start. Never commit .env.
```

PURPOSE

Start Review 3 with a secure, conventional Express setup.

FILES

server/package.json, server/src/app.js, server/src/index.js, server/.env.example

P6 Mongoose data models

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Design Mongoose schemas with validation and indexes to replace the 15 SQLite tables: User (name, email unique and lowercase, passwordHash, preferences), Category (user, or null for defaults; name; type expense or income; icon; color), Expense and Income (user, category, amount stored as integer paise, date, description or source, paymentMethod), Budget (user, category or null, month, year, limit; unique on user+category+month+year), Recurring (name, amount, frequency, startDate, nextDueDate, active), Group (name, description, createdBy, members [{user, role admin|member, joinedAt}]), SharedExpense (group, title, amount, paidBy, category, date, splitType, shares [{user, amount}] with a validator that the shares sum to the amount), Settlement (group, payer, payee, amount, status, completedAt), ShoppingList (owner, optional group, name, budget, items [{name, quantity, estimatedPrice, actualPrice, purchased, assignedTo}], convertedExpense), Receipt (user, file reference, merchant, date, amount, rawText, confidence) and Insight (user, kind, message, read). Explain in comments which data is embedded and which is referenced, and why.
```

PURPOSE

Show MongoDB data modelling, the core of Review 3.

FILES

server/src/models/*.js

P7 Authentication and REST API

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Implement the REST API under /api with one express.Router per module, mirroring the 48 legacy Flask routes: /api/auth (register with bcrypt cost 12, login, logout, me), /api/expenses, /api/income, /api/categories, /api/budgets, /api/recurring (including toggle), /api/groups (members, shared expenses, balances, settlements, leave), /api/shopping (lists, items, toggle, convert to expense), /api/analytics (monthly, categories, forecast, insights) and /api/search. Validate every input with a schema (zod or express-validator), check ownership or group membership on every request, use MongoDB transactions for multi-document writes (recording a settlement, converting a list), and reuse the Review 2 settle.js and splits.js modules on the server so the algorithm has a single implementation.
```

PURPOSE

Deliver the Node.js back end with a complete, secure API.

FILES

server/src/routes/*.js, server/src/services/*.js, server/src/middleware/*.js

P8 Receipt upload and server-side OCR

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Add POST /api/receipts using multer with memory storage, a 5 MB limit and magic-byte checks for PNG, JPEG and WEBP; preprocess with sharp (rotate from EXIF, greyscale, upscale small images, normalise); run tesseract.js with one shared worker; parse the merchant, date and total with the Review 2 parser; store the image in MongoDB GridFS (so it survives redeploys on free hosting) and the parsed fields in Receipt. GET /api/receipts/:id/image streams the image only to its owner. Confirming creates the expense; nothing becomes an expense without confirmation.
```

PURPOSE

Port the OCR feature to Node with persistent storage.

FILES

server/src/routes/receipts.js, server/src/services/ocr.js

P9 Connect the client to the API

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Re-implement client/js/data/api.js with fetch() against /api, sending credentials and the CSRF token header, mapping HTTP errors to the same {field, message} errors the pages already handle, and showing a toast when offline. Remove the localStorage store except for the theme preference. Because the page code depends only on api.js, no page module should need changes; confirm this by running every flow end to end against a local server connected to Atlas.
```

PURPOSE

Finish the full-stack integration.

FILES

client/js/data/api.js

P10 Seed data and automated tests

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Add server/scripts/seed.js that creates the demo user, categories, six months of expenses and income, budgets, recurring payments, the three groups with shared expenses, and shopping lists. It must be idempotent and must refuse to run against a database whose name does not end in -dev or -test unless --force is passed. Write Jest + Supertest tests using mongodb-memory-server for auth, ownership checks, CSRF rejection, rate limiting, split validation, the settlement algorithm, budget status, convert-to-expense duplicate prevention and receipt upload validation, covering what the 47 legacy Python tests checked. Add an npm test script and a GitHub Actions workflow that runs lint and tests on every push.
```

PURPOSE

Prove the back end works and keep it working.

FILES

server/scripts/seed.js, server/tests/*.test.js, .github/workflows/ci.yml

Wrap-up - Documentation, cleanup and deployment

P11 Remove legacy code, document and deploy

Planned prompt

PROMPT

```
Delete the Flask app (app.py, config.py, database/, modules/, templates/, static/, ml/,
tests/*.py, requirements.txt, Procfile) from main, since it is kept on the legacy branch.
Rewrite README.md: features, the stack per review (HTML+CSS, JavaScript, Node.js+MongoDB),
setup steps, environment variables, a data-model diagram, the API table and screenshots.
Deploy the full app to Render as a Node web service (build: npm ci; start: npm start;
environment: MONGODB_URI, SESSION_SECRET, NODE_ENV=production) with MongoDB Atlas network
access configured, and keep the static site on GitHub Pages. Finish the prompt log, export it
to Word and PDF, and tag the release v3.0.0.
```

PURPOSE

Deliver a clean, documented, deployed project.

FILES

README.md, render.yaml, docs/*